

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN

QUESTION PAPER FOR 1st PRE-BOARD EXAMINATION (2024-25)

SUBJECT – ENGLISH COMMUNICATIVE

CLASS – X

MAXIMUM MARKS – 80

TIME – 3 Hrs

SET – 1

General Instructions:

Read the following instructions very carefully and strictly follow them.

- I. The Question paper has 10 questions. All questions are compulsory.**
- II. The Question paper contains four sections:**
Section A: Reading Skills
Section B: Writing Skills
Section C: Grammar
Section D: Literature Textbook
- III. Attempt all questions based on specific instructions for each part. Write the correct question number and part thereof in your answer sheet.**
- IV. Separate instructions are given with each question / part, wherever necessary.**
- V. Adhere to the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.**

Section A: Reading Skills (22 marks)

Q.1 Read the following passage:- 12marks

1. India is rushing headlong towards economic success and modernisation, counting on high tech industries such as information technology and biotechnology to propel the nation to prosperity. India's recent announcement that it would no longer produce unlicensed inexpensive generic pharmaceuticals bowed to the realities of the World Trade Organisation while at the same time challenging the domestic drug industry to compete with the multinational firms. Unfortunately, its weak higher education sector constitutes the Achilles' heel of this strategy. Its systematic disinvestment in higher education in recent years has yielded neither world-class research nor very many highly trained scholars, scientists or managers to sustain high-tech development.

2. India's main competitors – especially China but also Singapore, Taiwan and South Korea – are investing in large and differentiated higher education systems. They are providing access to large numbers of students at the bottom of the academic system while at the same time building some research-based universities that are able to compete with the world's best institutions. The recent London Times Higher Education Supplement ranking of the world's top 200 universities included three in China, three in Hong Kong, three in South Korea, one in Taiwan, and one in India. These countries are positioning themselves for leadership in the knowledge-based economies of the coming era.

3. There was a time when countries could achieve economic success with cheap labour and low-tech manufacturing. Low wages still help, but contemporary large-scale development requires a sophisticated and at least partly knowledge-based economy. India has chosen that path, but will find a major stumbling block in its university system.

4. India has significant advantages in the 21st century knowledge race. It has a large higher

education sector the third largest in the world in student numbers, after China and the United States. It uses English as a primary language of higher education and research. It has a long academic tradition. Academic freedom is respected. There are a small number of high-quality institutions, departments, and centres that can form the basis of quality sector in higher education. The fact that the states, rather than the Central Government, exercise major responsibility for higher education creates a rather cumbersome structure, but the system allows for a variety of policies and approaches.

5. Yet the weakness far outweighs the strengths. India educates approximately 10 percent of its young people in higher education compared with more than half in the major industrialised countries and 15 percent in China. Almost all of the world's academic systems resemble a pyramid, with a small high-quality tier at the top and a massive sector at the bottom. India has a tiny top tier. None of its universities occupies a solid position at the top. A few of the best universities have some excellent departments and centres, and there are a small number of outstanding undergraduate colleges. The University Grants Commission's recent major support of five universities to build on their recognised strength is a step towards recognising a differentiated academic system and fostering excellence. These universities, combined, enrol well under one percent of the student population.

Based on the understanding of the passage, answer the following questions: -

(I) Which of the following is true in the context of the passage? 1 mark

- (a) The top five Universities in India educate more than 10 percent of the Indian student population.
- (b) India's higher education sector is the largest in the world.
- (c) In the past, countries could progress economically through low manufacturing cost as well as low wages of labourers.
- (d) All of these.

(II) Which of the following is / are India's strength(s) in terms of higher education?

1 mark

- A. Its system of higher education allows variations.
 - B. Medium of instruction for most higher learning is English.
 - C. It has the paraphernalia, albeit small in number, to build a high quality higher educational sector.
- (a) Only B (b) Only A & B (c) Only C (d) All A, B, C

(III) Which of the following is possibly the most appropriate title for the passage?

1 mark

- (a) The future of Indian Universities.
- (b) Methods of overcoming the Educational Deficit in India.
- (c) India and the Hunt for a Knowledge Based Economy.
- (d) Indian Economy Vs Chinese Economy

(IV) What does the phrase 'Achilles'heel' mean as used in the passage? 1 mark

- (a) weakness (b) Quickness (c) Low quality (d) Nimbleness

(V) Choose the antonym of the word 'massive'. (para-5)

1 mark

(a) enormous (b) gigantic (c) miniature (d) hefty

(VI) State whether the following statement is True or False. 1 mark

India has the least percentage of young population taking to higher education as compared to the rest of the comparable countries.

(VII) Find a word from paragraph – 5 which has the same meaning as “mirror”.

1 mark

(VIII) What did India agree to do at the behest of the World Trade Organisation?

1 mark

(IX) What are needed for the economic success of a country, according to the passage? 2 marks

(X) What are Asian countries other than India, doing to head towards a knowledge-based economy? (two points) 2 marks

Q.2. Read the passage given below: 10marks

1. Peer pressure is a phenomenon wherein we tend to get influenced by the life style and the ways of thinking of our peers. Peer pressure can prove beneficial but it is most often observed to have negative effects.

2. The thought, behaviour and taste in fashion music, television and other walks of life of the masses are often seen to have a deep impact on society. We tend to get influenced by the lifestyle of our peer group. The changing ways of life of our peers often force us to change our ways of looking at life and leading it. It is a human tendency to do what the crowd does. Few have the courage to resist the peer pressure and be their own selves.

3. Peer pressure is bound to affect most of us both positively and negatively. The distinction between positive and negative peer pressure lies in a thoughtful analysis of the views of the masses. Following your peers blindly leaves a negative impact on your life while an analytical approach of looking at peer behaviour can help you act positively.

4. Peer pressure is not always bad. It can help you analyse yourself and contemplate on your ways of life. Some of the practices that the masses follow may actually teach you the way of living. You may be able to change yourself for the better. Looking at what others do, can help you bring about a positive change in your way of thinking. If you can pick selectively, peer pressure can actually result in a positive change in your way of life.

5. Teenage is that phase of life when you are exposed to the world outside. These are the years when you spend most of your time with your friends. Teenage is the phase of beginning to become independent in life, the years of forming your ideals and principles, the years that shape your personality and the years that introduce you to your own self. As adolescents you often spend most of your daily time with friends and owing to this, you tend

to imitate your friends. The people around you are bound to influence you.

6. Parents and teachers need to be careful while dealing with teenagers, as they are most susceptible to succumb to peer pressure during these years of their life. Teenage individuals need to be taught to distinguish between the good and the bad, the right and the wrong and should be taught to be thoughtful in life.

7. A strong support from family, an ability to differentiate between positive and the negative and a skill to choose friends from among the peers – this pronged strategy is the best way to keep away from negative peer pressure.

Answer the following questions based on the passage above.

(I) How can changing ways of life of our peers affect us? 1 mark

- (a) It affects our taste in music.
- (b) It forces us to change the ways in which we lead our lives.
- (c) It makes us moody and temperamental
- (d) All of the above

(II) Choose the option that best captures the central idea of the passage from given quotes. 1 mark

- (a) “Stay true to yourself. An original is worth more than a copy.” – Suzy Kassem
- (b) “I’m not in this world to live up to your expectations and you’re not in this world to live up to mine.” – Bruce Lee
- (c) “People either inspire you or they drain you, choose wisely. – Hans F Hansen
- (d) “Those who stand for nothing fall for anything” – Alexander Hamilton

(III) With what approach can we obtain the positive benefits of peer pressure? 1 mark

- (a) Selective approach (b) Open – minded approach
- (c) Observation approach (d) Demonstrative approach

(IV) Choose the option that correctly states the meaning of ‘exposed’ as used in the passage (para 5) 1 mark

A. susceptible B. concealed C. vulnerable D. shielded E. sheltered F. protected

- (a) D and E (b) A and C
- (c) E and F (d) B and D

(V) Select the option that makes the correct use of ‘succumb’ as used in the passage. 1 mark

- (a) He succumbed the project and impressed his boss.
- (b) Thousands of cows have succumbed to the disease in the past few months.
- (c) They succumbed the mountain and reached the peak at dawn.
- (d) After negotiating for hours, he succumbed the deal and got a great discount

(VI) Why do we all often try to go with the flow, according to the author? 1 mark

(VII) What are the typical traits seen in teenagers? 2 marks

(VIII) What is the multi- dimensional approach that can ensure a positive gain from peer pressure? 2 marks

Section: B (Writing) 22 marks

Q.3. You are Rachita Verma / Ronit Verma, the Girl-captain/ Boy-captain of DAV Public School, Nagpur. Write an email to the Principal of your School requesting permission to organise a cleanliness drive in your school campus. You should include the purpose of the drive and how that will be organised. You may copy the given template to write your email.

3 marks

From:	
To:	
Cc:	
Date:	
Subject:	

Q.4. Write a factual description, in not more than 100 words, of your most favourite inanimate object. (Object or thing that is not alive and does not possess the qualities of life)

4 marks

5.A. You are Saurabh Srivastava / Surabhi Srivastava. Recently you read a report on increasing stress level among the younger generation due to various reasons. You are disturbed with the scenario. You decided to write a letter to the Editor of a national daily expressing your concern and also about some measures which can be adopted by the youth to overcome stress. On the basis of the ideas reflected in the Unit-1('Health and Medicine') of MCB and your own understanding, write the letter to the Editor in not more than 120 words.

7 marks

OR

B. Safe drinking water is becoming scarce day by day. Industrial development is filling our rivers, seas and oceans with toxic pollutants which are a major threat to human health. You are deeply saddened to see water pollution as an appalling problem, which has also become an international issue. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily to make the public aware about the causes of water pollution and also suggest the measures to prevent water pollution in not more than 120 words. .

7 marks

6.A. 'The world is a book, and those who do not travel read only one page.' Tourism is a booming industry. It can foster understanding between people and cultures. At the same time, it also causes cultural destruction. It offers both opportunities and challenges to society. Write an article on the topic 'The Two Sides of Tourism Industry' in about 150 words with the ideas from Unit-5(Travel and Tourism) of MCB,your own ideas and ideas from the given cues. .

8 marks

Cues.

- Books give us knowledge but Travelling gives us experiences.
- Helps people to develop mutual sympathy and understanding
- Creates jobs, motivates to reduce emigration from rural areas
- Causes pollution and habitat destruction
- Increases crimes, Cultural commodification

- Responsible tourism required

OR

B. Recently you have celebrated 'National Unity Day' and have taken pledge to be united. Unity in diversity is our goal. We all know that unity is strength. Education plays a significant role in promoting unity and how to inculcate the spirit of being united. Write an article on 'The Role of Education in promoting National Integration'. You are Anurag Gupta or Ankita Gupta, of XA, PM SHRI K.V.No.2 Hyderabad. Use the cues, along with your own ideas and those you may have collected from Unit – 6 (National Integration) to write this article **8 marks**

Cues:

- Education is a powerful tool that shapes minds, builds character and influences perspectives.
- Education – as a unifying force
- Curriculum & national Integration
- Educational programmes & events
- Role of Teachers & Educational Institutions

Section: C (Grammar) 10 marks

Q.7. Complete the tasks (A) to (C) as directed.

A. Fill in the blanks (I) – (III) with the appropriate option from those in the brackets.

Effective speaking (I) _____ (depended / has depended / depends / depend) on effective listening. It takes energy to concentrate (II) _____ (by / for / on / at) hearing and understanding what has been heard. Incompetent listeners (III) _____ (failed / have failed / fail / fails) in a number of ways.

B. There is an error in each line. Write the incorrect word and the correct word against the corresponding blanks. **1x4=4 marks**

	Incorrect	correct
Demonetization is the withdrawal of the particular form (I) _____	_____	_____
of currency for circulation. Through demonetization, (II) _____	_____	_____
the old currency is replaced by a new currency or a (III) _____	_____	_____
currency circulation is blocked. There were multiple (IV) _____	_____	_____
reasons for demonetization.		

C. Do as directed. 1x3=3 marks

(I) Rearrange the following jumbled words / phrases in the given dialogue to create a meaningful sentence.

Rajiv: What is the national sport of Bhutan?

Ranbir: Archery. I have heard that the archers of Bhutan are very committed while in the field.

Rajiv: **pay no heed / Yes, / the plunging temperature / to / of winter / they / when / compete in / propelling arrows / archers of Bhutan / field / across / a**

Report the dialogue to complete the paragraph that follows:

Anup: Where can we meet tomorrow?

Atul: I may not be able to meet you tomorrow.

Anup: Are you going to be busy?

Atul: Yes, I will be travelling tomorrow. We can meet next week.

Anup asked Atul **(II)** _____. Atul replied that he might not be able to meet him the next day. Anup asked **(III)** _____. Atul said that he would be travelling the next day. He further added that they could meet next week.

SECTION: D (Literature Textbook) 26 marks

8. Read the given excerpts and answer the questions briefly, for any two excerpts, of the given three, (A), (B) & (C) 4 + 4 = 8 marks

(A)He reflected deeply, and came to the conclusion that the whole universe was build up through love and that the grief of separation was inescapable.**The Letter**

(I)Who is 'he' in the above paragraph?**1 mark**

(II)When did 'he' realise this philosophy?**1 m**

(III)What pain did 'he' go through?**1 mark**

(IV)What follow up action did 'he' take on this reflection?**1 mark**

(B). "Cowards die many times before their death;

The valiant never taste of death but once,

of all the wonders that I yet have heard,

It seems to me most strange that men should fear;

seeing that death, a necessary end,

will come when it will come". **Julius Caesar**

(I) Who is the speaker of the above lines?**1 mark**

(II) In which context the speaker is uttering the above lines.**1 mark**

(III) Which qualities of the speaker are revealed here?**1 mark**

(IV) Explain the first two lines.**1 mark**

(C)"Gainst death and all oblivious enmity

Shall you pace forth; your praise shall still find room,
Even in the eyes of all posterity
That wear this world out to the ending doom.

(Not marble, nor the Gilded monuments)

(I) Who is 'you' mentioned in the second line of this excerpt? **1 mark**

(II) What do you mean by 'oblivious'? Why is enmity referred as oblivious? **1 mark**

(III) What do you mean by 'the ending doom'? **1 mark**

(IV) What is the tone of the above lines? **1 mark**

Q.9. Answer any five of the following six questions in about 40 words each. 2X5=10 marks

(I) Who was Gogon Pakrashi? What did he preach Patol Babu?

(II) Bring out the irony in the frog's statement 'Your song must be your own'.

(III) Why were the two boys at the deserted square at night? What character traits do they exhibit?

(IV) What are the three things that grandfather plans to do on Monday next

(V) How did Decius Brutus interpret the dream of Calpurnia?

(VI) Why is the post office referred to as Ali's place of pilgrimage? Which traits (any two) of Ali did it reflect?

10. Answer any one of the following two questions in about 150 words. 1x8=8 marks

(I) The theme of sin, repentance and redemption is central to the poem 'The Rime of The Ancient Mariner' by S.T. Coleridge as well as the poem 'Snake' by D.H. Lawrence. Elaborate.

OR

(II) "None are so empty as those who are full of themselves." Compare and contrast the characters of Mrs. Packletide and Ozymandias in the light of this statement.
